You get most benefits just from getting in

Channel: Tim Luong · Published: Nov 08, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/e7S3c_QhDZ0 Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

The speaker argues that university admission itself signals ~90% of the credential value employers care about, making four full years of tuition largely unnecessary — and that trend is only growing.

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🎓 The Core Argument: Admission Is the Real Signal 0:00

- The speaker states that if he could go back, he would enroll in university and then drop out after the first semester
  - His reasoning: **90% of the benefit** comes simply from being accepted into a good university
  - The admission itself is the signal that matters to other people — it proves you were capable of getting in
- The implication is that paying four years of tuition is largely redundant once that signal has been established
  - People don't need to see that you *completed* the degree
  - They only need to see that you were able to get into a good school in the first place

📉 The Declining Importance of Degree Completion 0:22

- Even beyond his personal opinion, the speaker observes that society's attention to degree completion is fading over time
  - "People care less and less about this as time goes on"
  - The trend suggests the credential gap between completers and non-completers is narrowing in the eyes of employers and the broader public